

are applicable to all projects, including security; governance, operations and ecosystem development; licensing and IPR; training and certification; and open source business programme development.

The event will be held from March 29-31 in 2016; it will have the Open Networking Summit, NFV, the open networking space, and the OpenIoT Summit. This event will be part of the Embedded Linux Conference North America, where embedded and application developers as well as systems architects and firmware developers will meet to advance the technical work needed for the future of IoT.

Alcatel-Lucent ties up with cloud software firms

Alcatel-Lucent has collaborated with leading cloud software and hardware companies like Red Hat, Advantech and 6WIND to boost the roll out of commercial, virtualised radio access network (vRAN) products. The aim of the collaboration is to improve Alcatel-Lucent's vRAN technology, working on the CloudBand NFV platform, to ensure that it complies with service providers' wide performance and reliability needs.

In the wake of increasing consumer demand for video data applications, along with the growth of the IoT and the launch of 5G wireless technology, service providers are looking to optimise their networks to allow new cost and operational efficiencies.

With these collaborations, Alcatel-Lucent aims to offer a complete NFV-



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compliant virtualised radio access network, which will meet with the high-performance, high-availability cloud requirements. Glenn Booth, VP of wireless portfolio management and strategy at Alcatel-Lucent, stated that the firm is leading in vRAN technology and makes use of a strategy of collaboration that combines leading third-party technologies, and ensures delivery of high quality products that meet the individual requirements of the service providers' customers.

"By associating with Red Hat, Advantech and 6WIND, we are boosting the availability of our vRAN, and offering our operators the flexibility and efficiency they need on a large scale for meeting subscriber data demand into the future," Booth stated.

Airplane mode to be integrated in GNOME 3.20

The airplane mode has been implemented by a number of hardware makers and companies for turning off any type of radio emissions which may interfere with the airplane's avionics. This mode allows people to use their laptops, phones, etc, while they are on the airplane. It also helps in maximising battery life. Of late, GNOME developers have also been working together to get the feature ready for its GNOME 3.20 version, which will be arriving in a couple of months.



According to developer Bastien Nocera, "As we were working on audio jack notifications, and were wondering whether the type of notification we'd pop up, in this case, could be reused in other cases, I encountered a feature request that could now be solved easily with the rkill D-Bus service we added to gnome-settings-daemon for the 3.10 release. If you have keyboard buttons on your laptop to enable or disable Bluetooth, or airplane mode, you can now use them."

GNOME 3.20 is going to be available on March 23, 2016.

Open Ledger Project by Linux Foundation

The Linux Foundation has made an announcement regarding a collaboration between industries for developing blockchain technology. The project is called the Open Ledger Project. It is going to create an enterprise grade, open source distributed ledger framework which will focus on creating strong, industry-specific applications, platforms and hardware systems for supporting business transactions. The early contenders for the project are Accenture, Digital Asset Holdings, IBM, J.P. Morgan and Wells Fargo. Several founding members are in the process of doing substantial research and development work to explore blockchain applications for industry.

IBM will be contributing tens of thousands of lines of its existing code base and intellectual property for this community. Digital Asset will be contributing the Hyperledger mark that is going to be used as the project name, along with enterprise-grade code and developer resources.

The SEC had already approved Overstock.com's registration statement for sale of securities through blockchain technology. The Nasdaq Private Market is also going to trade shares using this technology in its pilot project.

There are obviously going to be risks linked with the technology's large scale implementation. The technology, however, will have to prove its scalability for handling global settlement streams. This will include sufficient data processing and storage power for solving complex algorithms, which are essential for transferring property and maintaining ledgers. There will also be a need for global cooperation between financial institutions and regulators for the system to remain open and non-proprietary. Issues including hacking, confidentiality, money laundering and terrorism have to be addressed.